SARA AHARON

GEOSPATIAL ANALYST

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PROFILE SUMMARY

Geospatial analyst with research experience in Earth Observation, specializing in cloud-based spatial analysis, remote sensing and environmental monitoring. Skilled in Google Earth Engine, QGIS and ArcGIS, applying Sentinel-2, Landsat and VIIRS nighttime lights data to urban expansion, green infrastructure dynamics and coastal geomorphology. Published at ECRS 2026 (MDPI), 2nd Prize at the "Mihai David" National Student Symposium, and presenter at the ASI-CEOS international workshop.

EDUCATION & ACADEMIC HONORS

B.Sc. in Territorial Planning Oct 2024 – Present
Alexandru Ioan Cuza University of Iași, Faculty of Geography and Geology | Iași, Romania

- **Academic Merit Scholarship Recipient** (2024–2025 & 2025–2026)
- **1st Prize – Top Student:** Ranked 1st overall in Territorial Planning specialization (Year 1 & Year 2)

Academia RATIO XVI – Summer School Aug 2026 – Sept 2026
Babeș-Bolyai University, Faculty of Economics and Business Administration | Cluj-Napoca, Romania

Erasmus+ BIP – Safe Mountain Explorer 15–19 Jun 2026
Wrocław University of Health and Sport Sciences | Wrocław, Poland

Just & Resilient Communities – Field Research Program 16–23 May 2026
Van Hall Larenstein Univ. (NL), ADR Nord-Est, & UAIC | Piatra Neamț, Romania

- Field research on community livelihoods to develop actionable policy recommendations for local authorities.

European Economic Studies Oct 2013 – Jun 2014
Romanian-American University | Bucharest, Romania

RESEARCH PROJECTS & PUBLICATIONS

Cloud-Based Monitoring of 20 Years of Shoreline Change on Ko Phi Phi Don, Thailand Jun 2026 – Oct 2026

- **Publication & Oral Presentation:** Aharon, S. (2026). Cloud-Based Monitoring of Twenty Years of Shoreline Change on Ko Phi Phi Don, Thailand, Using Google Earth Engine and Multi-Temporal Satellite Imagery. *Proc. 6th Int. Electronic Conf. on Remote Sensing (ECRS 2026)*, MDPI, Basel, Switzerland.
- Quantified 20 years of shoreline change across 21 transects: average retreat of 56 m (up to 117 m at the most affected transect), with 1.01 km² lost to erosion against 0.25 km² gained through accretion.

Earth Observation for Disaster Risk Management 16 Sept 2026

- **Poster Presentation:** Italian Space Agency (ASI) & CEOS WGD International Workshop | Rome, Italy
- Developed and presented a scientific research poster on satellite Earth Observation techniques applied to disaster risk assessment and environmental monitoring.

Spatio-Temporal Dynamics of Urban Green Infrastructure – Focșani Municipality (1990–2025) 20 Nov 2025

- **2nd Prize Winner & Oral Presentation:** "Mihai David" National Student Symposium (15th Ed., UAIC Iași)
- Combined NDVI, NDBI, land surface temperature and population density (Sentinel-2, Landsat 8/9, GHS-POP) across Focșani and 10 neighboring localities. Built-up area grew 26.6% (1995-2025) while population fell 16.8%, peak NDVI dropped ~29% (2015-2024), and mean annual temperature rose ~2°C. Clustering identified 4 urban typologies.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & QUALIFICATIONS

GIS & Remote Sensing: QGIS, ArcGIS, Google Earth Engine, Landsat, Sentinel-2, Copernicus, NDVI, NDWI, NDBI, LST

Data & Development: Python, SQL, VS Code, HTML, CSS, GitHub Pages, Geospatial Data Analysis

Aviation License: EASA A1/A3 Open Sub Category Drone Pilot License (Valid to Dec 2030)

Languages: Romanian (Native), English (C1 – Fluent), Spanish (Intermediate), German (Beginner)

CONFERENCES, SYMPOSIA & WORKSHOPS

EVENT	ORGANIZATION / LOCATION	DATE	ROLE
Int. Geographic Seminar "Dimitrie Cantemir" (46th Ed.)	UAIC Iași	Oct 2026	Oral Presentation
6th Int. Electronic Conf. on Remote Sensing (ECRS 2026)	MDPI	Oct 2026	Oral Presentation
ASI-CEOS WGD Workshop on EO for DRM	Italian Space Agency (ASI), Rome, Italy	Sept 2026	Poster Presentation
JUST4MPA Conference: Blue Justice & Social Equity	University of Bucharest	Jun 2026	Participant
National Conference "George Vâlsan"	Babeș-Bolyai University, Cluj-Napoca	May 2026	Oral Presentation
Annual Scientific Communications Session (31st Ed.)	University of Craiova	May 2026	Oral Presentation
Hyperspectral Remote Sensing Workshop	ASI, DLR, ROSA & POLITEHNICA Bucharest	Apr 2026	Participant
GISRS International Symposium (Spring Ed., 32nd Ed.)	UAIC Iași	Mar 2026	Oral Presentation
National Symposium of Student Geographers (32nd Ed.)	CCMESI & University of Bucharest	Mar 2026	Oral Presentation
geo-spatial.org Seminars (45th Ed.)	Chișinău, Republic of Moldova	Mar 2026	Oral Presentation
"Mihai David" National Student Symposium (15th Ed.)	UAIC Iași	Nov 2025	Oral (2nd Place)
TELLURIA Youth Conference for Earth Sciences (2nd Ed.)	UAIC Iași	Nov 2025	Oral Presentation
Climate Change Summit 2025	Palace of Parliament, Bucharest	Oct 2025	Participant

CIVIC ENGAGEMENT & LEADERSHIP

Student Policy Delegate Sept 2025

Forum of Romanian Students Worldwide | Min. of Labour, Family, Youth & Union of Romanian Students, Bucharest

- Collaborated with student delegates from Romania and the diaspora to draft consensus-based youth policy recommendations for formal ministerial consideration.

Environmental Fieldwork & Documentary Contributor Sept 2025

V.O.T.C.A. Project | Min. of Labour & ETH Student League | Vatra Dornei, Suceava, Romania

- Participated in mountain environmental field evaluations and documentary film production (*Vreau O Țară Ca Afară*, 2025) assessing ecological conditions and community impact.

Youth Mentor & Cultural Guide Aug 2024

ARC Camps | Dept. for Romanians Everywhere (Government of Romania) | Tulnici, Vrancea, Romania

- Guided and mentored 50 youth from the Romanian diaspora in Ukraine and Moldova during a one-week cultural exchange program focused on heritage and identity reconnection.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Operations Manager June 2015 – Jan 2024

Dead Freddies LLC | Ocean City, Maryland, United States

- Directed daily operations of a 1,000+ seat hospitality venue, leading a multinational team of 200 staff members.
- Developed high-level leadership, crisis management, cross-cultural communication, and operational problem-solving capabilities.

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

- **GIS & Cartography:** ESRI: GIS for Climate Action (Mar 2026), Going Places with Spatial Analysis (Feb 2026), GIS Basics (Feb 2026), ArcGIS Imagery MOOC (Nov 2025), Cartography (Oct 2025), Modern Geo Apps (May 2025) | NASA: Fundamentals of Remote Sensing (Nov 2025)
- **Climate, Nature & Conservation:** IUCN Academy (Aug 2026): Synthetic Biology in Nature Conservation, Mapping Biodiversity Priorities, Finance for Nature, Conservation & Agriculture, Cities & Nature, Conservation & Climate Change, United for Nature & Society, Nature World Heritage | RECOFTC: Community Forestry 101 (Jul 2026) | HP Foundation: Circular Economy (May 2025)
- **Data, AI & Open Science:** Esri on AWS: The Rise of GeoAI (Feb 2026) | NASA: Open Science 101 & Essentials (Feb 2026) | AWS: Fundamentals of ML and AI (Jan 2026) | Google Cloud: Intro to Generative AI (Jan 2026) | HP Foundation: Data Science & Analytics (May 2025)
- **Technical:** ICDL/ECDL Romania: IT Skills Certification (Jan 2010)